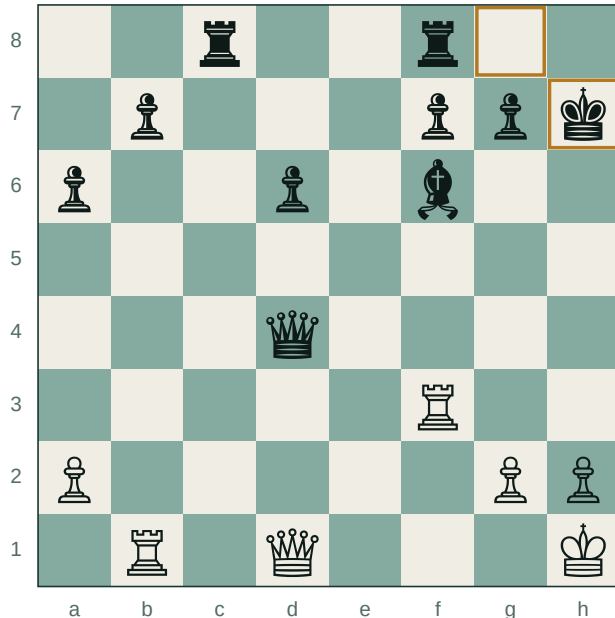


Clearance tactics: White, move 27

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 26...Kxh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Rh3+ Kg8 28. Qh5 Qh4 29. Rxh4 Bxh4 30. Qxh4

27.Rh3+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **27...Kg8**.

28.Qh5 The queen moves from d1 to h5. Recorded reply: **28...Qh4**.

29.Rxh4 The rook captures the queen on h4. Recorded reply: **29...Bxh4**.

30.Qxh4 The queen captures the bishop on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -5 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on h7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.